BLUEPRINT FOR BETTER TASTE

Step inside the high-performance cooking zones to learn why visibility, precision and zero-clutter are the secret ingredients to great food

By RIDHI KALE

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ALL ABOUT EFFICIENCY

Chef Radhika Khandelwal doesn't just run kitchens; she engineers ecosystems. As the force behind Trouble Trouble, Kona and Three Little Figs, Khandelwal balances a high-profile roster—ranging from private jets and embassies to brands like Spotify and Huda Beauty—with a grounded, producer-first philosophy. For her, the ultimate kitchen design is a marriage of industrial efficiency and raw seasonal transparency.

OPEN SHELVES AND ISLAND VIBES

Khandelwal champions a domestic layout that prioritises visibility. Her ideal space swaps bulky cabinets for open shelving. "I like to see what I can grab at all times," she says. To elevate a home kitchen, she suggests, hanging pan racks to avoid stacking to maintain the longevity of your cookware; dedicated spice zones to keep your aromatics organised but accessible; and island cooking, shifting the stove to a central island turns cooking into a shared, social activity rather than a solitary chore.

THE SHOWSTOPPER

The crown jewel of her redesigned space is the Churrascaria, a custom-built Brazilian grill designed alongside Anirudh Singhal of SpeedX. Unique to the Delhi culinary scene, this four-level grill is a masterclass in efficiency. The vertical heat management allows for simultaneous techniques and styles of cooking.

Khandelwal remains proudly cuisine agnostic, focusing on decade-long ties with local farmers rather than culinary labels. "What drives food is seasonality," she explains. For her, the chef is merely the final link between exceptional produce and the guest, a role she considers a privilege.